DFW Roof Inspection After Severe Storms: What to Check First

NWS Fort Worth flagged tornado, severe thunderstorm, lightning, and flash-flood risks for the Fort Worth area on November 7, 2026, days after a cold front drove 60 mph wind gusts and quarter-size hail across North Texas (Source: NWS Fort Worth, November 2026). After a system like this passes, inspect your roof from the ground for lifted or missing shingles, dented metal, and debris, then schedule a professional roof inspection before filing anything with your insurer. Wind gusts near 60 mph can cause damage similar to a weak tornado, so visible calm does not mean your roof is intact.

The short answer: After severe wind and hail in Dallas-Fort Worth, do a safe ground-level check for missing shingles, dented vents, and granule buildup in gutters, then book a professional roof inspection to document damage.

Who this affects: Homeowners across the I-35 corridor and DFW suburbs hit by the recent 60 mph gusts and quarter-size hail - especially those with roofs over 10 years old.

What to do: Photograph visible damage from the ground and arrange a documented roof inspection before contacting your insurer.

Timeline: Within 1-2 weeks of the storm, and before the next severe system moves through.

TC Roofing & Restorations uses AI drone inspection to document hail impact patterns, granule loss, and lifted shingles across the full roof surface, producing dated photographs and a line-item estimate before a claim is filed.

What Should DFW Homeowners Inspect on Their Roof After the Storm?

Start with a safe, ground-level walk-around looking for missing or curled shingles, dented metal flashing, bent gutters, and shingle granules collecting at downspouts. The recent North Texas front brought damaging wind gusts up to 60 mph plus hail up to the size of quarters, both of which strip protective granules and loosen fasteners (Source: Fox 4, November 2026). In older neighborhoods like Richardson and Garland, where many ranch-style homes still carry original or single-layer asphalt roofs, quarter-size hail commonly fractures aging shingles that already lost flexibility to Texas heat. Check interior ceilings and attic decking for fresh water stains too, since flash flooding and wind-driven rain exploit even small openings. Document everything with timestamped photos - stay off the roof itself and leave the elevated inspection to a professional.

Which DFW Neighborhoods Face the Highest Wind and Hail Risk?

Areas along the I-35 corridor and the northern and western suburbs sit directly in the path the recent storm system followed as it swept through North Texas. The front developed to the north and west between 4 p.m. and 6 p.m. before pushing toward the I-35 corridor by 10 p.m., exposing communities from Denton down through Fort Worth to the strongest gusts (Source: Fox 4, November 2026). In Frisco and McKinney, rapid 2000s-era subdivision growth means thousands of roofs are now 15 to 20 years old and reaching the end of their shingle lifespan, making them vulnerable to wind uplift at eaves and ridges. Plano's mix of mature two-story homes often has steep roof planes where high winds catch and peel shingle tabs. Grapevine and Southlake carry many 1990s and early-2000s builds where flashing at roof-to-wall joints and chimneys has aged,

letting wind-driven rain intrude. In lower-lying parts of Arlington and Irving, the flash-flood threat NWS cited compounds roof problems by backing water up at clogged valleys and drains. Keller and Flower Mound homes on elevated terrain frequently take the brunt of gusts with little windbreak, loosening ridge caps.

As a GAF Master Elite-certified contractor serving the entire Dallas-Fort Worth Metroplex, TC Roofing & Restorations carries enhanced manufacturer warranties that uncertified installers cannot offer on roof replacement work.

How Does DFW's Hail Season Affect When You Should Inspect?

Dallas-Fort Worth faces two distinct severe-weather windows: the spring hail season from March through June and a secondary fall peak when strong cold fronts collide with warm air - exactly the pattern behind the early-November system. The recent front dropped temperatures from 85 degrees to about 73 behind it, the kind of sharp gradient that fuels damaging wind and hail (Source: Fox 4, November 2026). The 2016 Wylie-area hailstorm remains a reference point for how a single supercell can cause widespread roof damage across Collin County in minutes. Because fall storms arrive after a long, hot summer that already degrades shingles, roofs entering the cooler months are often more brittle and more likely to crack under hail impact. Schedule an inspection after each severe event rather than waiting for an annual checkup.

How Do Aging Shingles and Failed Flashing Turn Into Denied Claims?

Insurers often deny storm claims when they attribute damage to wear, poor maintenance, or installation defects rather than the storm itself - and aging roof components make that argument easy for an adjuster. Cracked, brittle shingles that lost granules to years of Texas sun can look like age-related deterioration even when hail caused the fresh fractures. Failed flashing at chimneys, skylights, and roof-to-wall joints - common on 1990s-era homes in Bedford and Carrollton - lets water in and gets labeled a maintenance issue instead of wind damage. Deferred repairs on a roof past 15 years give insurers room to reduce or reject a payout. A documented professional roof inspection draws the line between pre-existing wear and new storm damage, and timely roof repair or roof replacement removes the vulnerabilities that trigger denials. TC Roofing & Restorations provides storm damage restoration and insurance claim support, pairing dated drone photographs with line-item estimates that help substantiate what the storm actually caused.

Where Should DFW Homeowners Check and What Should They Do After the Storm?

DFW Area	Housing Type / Era	Roof Vulnerability	Homeowner Action
Frisco / McKinney	2000s subdivisions, 15-20 yr roofs	Wind uplift at eaves and ridges on aging shingles	Check ridge caps and eave shingles; book inspection

Grapevine / Southlake	1990s-2000s builds	Aged flashing at roof-to-wall and chimney joints	Inspect flashing seams for gaps and water stains
Richardson / Garland	Ranch homes, original asphalt	Hail fracturing brittle, heat-aged shingles	Look for granule loss in gutters; photograph pits
Arlington / Irving	Mixed, lower-lying lots	Flash-flood backup at valleys and clogged drains	Clear debris; check valleys and interior ceilings
Keller / Flower Mound	Elevated-terrain homes	Full-force gusts loosening ridge caps	Scan ridgeline for lifted or missing caps
Plano	Mature two-story homes	Steep planes catching wind, peeling tabs	Check upper slopes for lifted tabs after winds

What Steps Should You Take Right After the Storm?

Act in a clear sequence: ensure safety first, document second, then call a licensed contractor before your insurer. Do not climb onto a wet or damaged roof - the flash flooding NWS warned about makes surfaces slick and structurally uncertain (Source: NWS Fort Worth, November 2026). Photograph everything from the ground, including fallen branches, dented gutters, and granules in downspouts, and note the date and time. If you have an active leak, emergency roof tarping can prevent interior damage until permanent roof repair is scheduled. Then arrange a documented inspection so you have dated evidence and a line-item estimate before you open a claim, which strengthens your position with the adjuster.

FAQ

How soon after a DFW storm should I get my roof inspected?

Schedule a professional roof inspection within one to two weeks of a severe storm and before the next system arrives. Wind gusts near 60 mph and quarter-size hail can cause hidden damage - lifted fasteners and bruised shingles - that is not visible from the ground. Waiting lets small leaks spread and gives insurers room to attribute damage to age. A prompt, dated inspection captures the condition close to the storm event, which matters for any future claim.

Can 60 mph wind really damage my roof if I see no missing shingles?

Yes - 60 mph gusts can cause damage similar to a weak tornado even when no shingles are obviously gone. Wind lifts and reseats shingle tabs, breaking the adhesive seal and fasteners underneath, so the roof looks intact but is no longer watertight. It also loosens ridge caps and flashing, common failure points on elevated homes in Keller and Flower Mound. An AI drone inspection can spot these subtle lifts and seal failures that a ground view misses.

What does hail damage actually look like on an asphalt roof?

Hail damage appears as dark, bruised spots where granules are knocked loose, exposing the black asphalt mat underneath. You may see circular dents on soft metal like vents, gutters, and flashing, plus heavy granule accumulation at downspouts. Quarter-size hail, like the recent North Texas event, is large enough to fracture aging shingles in older Richardson and Garland neighborhoods. Since fresh hail bruises fade over time, photograph suspected damage quickly and have it documented.

Should I file an insurance claim before or after getting an inspection?

Get a documented inspection first, then decide on the claim. An inspection with dated photographs and a line-item estimate tells you whether the damage exceeds your deductible and gives you evidence the adjuster can verify. Filing blindly on minor damage can count against you, while filing without documentation weakens your case. TC Roofing & Restorations provides insurance claim support that helps homeowners enter the process prepared rather than guessing.

Why would my insurer blame storm damage on wear and tear?

Insurers may classify damage as age-related when a roof is old or poorly maintained, which reduces or denies the payout. Brittle, sun-degraded shingles and deteriorated flashing can resemble wear even when a storm caused the fresh damage - a frequent issue on 1990s homes in Bedford and Carrollton. A professional inspection distinguishes new storm damage from pre-existing deterioration. Keeping your roof repaired and documented before storms removes the ammunition for a wear-based denial.

Is my roof at higher risk because I live along the I-35 corridor?

Yes - the recent storm system intensified as it moved toward the I-35 corridor by 10 p.m., exposing those communities to the strongest gusts. Suburbs from Denton through Fort Worth sit in the common track of fast-moving cold fronts that generate wind and hail. Rapid-growth areas like Frisco and McKinney add risk because so many roofs there are now 15 to 20 years old. If you're along this corridor, inspect after every significant severe-weather event.

What should I do if water is already leaking into my house?

Contain the water immediately and arrange emergency roof tarping to stop further intrusion. Move belongings, place buckets under active drips, and photograph interior stains on ceilings and attic decking for your records. Flash flooding and wind-driven rain exploit small roof openings, so a leak often signals compromised flashing or lifted shingles above. Call a licensed contractor for temporary protection, then schedule permanent roof repair once the roof is dry and safe.

How do I choose a trustworthy roofing contractor after a DFW storm?

Choose a licensed, locally established contractor with manufacturer certification rather than an out-of-town door-knocker who appears after a storm. GAF Master Elite certification signals a vetted installer who qualifies for enhanced manufacturer warranties on roof replacement - a standing most storm-chasing crews cannot match. Ask for dated inspection photos, a written line-item estimate, and a physical DFW address. Verifying these details protects you from paying for work that is never properly completed.

Contact TC Roofing & Restorations for a free inspection.

Written by Jonathan Gil, Licensed Roofing Contractor, Dallas/Fort Worth Metroplex. TC Roofing & Restorations serves homeowners across the Dallas-Fort Worth Metroplex.